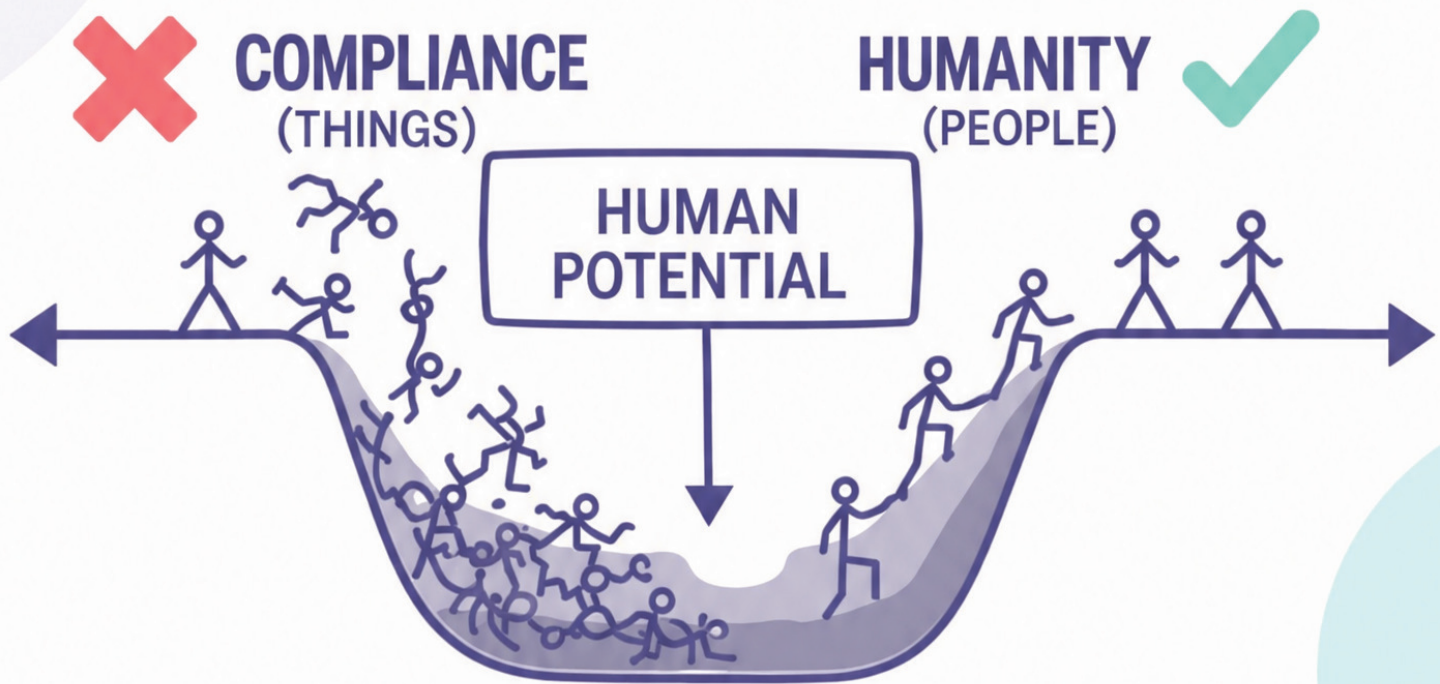


THINK SMALL START HORRIBLY



LEADER123

The Leadership Primer

ALEX COOPER

MY FIRST YEAR IN MANAGEMENT WAS A SHIT-SHOW OF ERRORS!!

...and I wouldn't trade it for the world.

Until I became a 'Leader', I was stuck operating from my position title of 'Manager' and making all the mistakes that come with it.

Here's a few things I learned along the way that will improve your experience of Leadership if you can implement them successfully.

10 THINGS I LEARNED THE HARD WAY

- 01 Forget all the bullshit.**
Stop overcomplicating things.
Start acting.
- 02 Invest in understanding and developing your communication skills.**
Your ability to lead is directly tied to your ability to communicate.
- 03 Invest in your people.**
People are the heartbeat of your success. Nurture that.
- 04 Write down what works and make a rule out of it.**
Success leaves clues. Capture them, systemise them, repeat them.
- 05 You'll learn more from your mistakes than your successes. You're supposed to.**
Celebrate both openly. Do the same for your people. If you're not failing, you're not growing. Celebrate the failures because they pave the way to success.
- 06 You don't have to take everyone's advice. Most of it will be garbage.**
Trust yourself enough to know which advice to ignore.
- 07 Don't be afraid to fail. You will. Yes, it exists.**
The only way to never fail is to never try. And that's not an option.
- 08 Seek out great mentors. Little tips will save you years.**
You don't know what you don't know. Let others help fill the gaps.
- 09 Know the difference between management and leadership.**
Management speaks to things. Leadership speaks to people. People don't like being treated like things. Lead with empathy, communicate with clarity.
- 10 Most importantly, TRUST YOURSELF.**
You'll find your feet and figure it out. You already have what it takes.

LEADERSHIP AND MANAGEMENT

RULE: PEOPLE DO NOT LIKE TO BE TREATED LIKE THINGS.

- There is a key difference between Leadership and Management...you MUST know it!
- LEADERSHIP speaks to people.
- MANAGEMENT speaks to things.
- This will resolve 90% of your challenges navigating the often-brutal terrain to becoming a Leader.
- Leadership earns loyalty, management earns compliance.
- Treat people as assets, not resources.
- People follow leaders they trust, not managers they fear.
- Empowerment beats control every time.
- Lead with humanity, manage with systems.

NOTES

ASK, DON'T TELL.

RULE: QUESTIONS LEAD TO ENGAGEMENT; COMMANDS SHUT DOWN CREATIVITY.

- Seek first to understand and then to be understood.
- People are far more open to the idea of change when they are not being TOLD to change.
- Ask great questions, get great information.
- Questions spark solutions, commands spark resistance.
- Curious leaders create empowered teams.
- Questions show respect for people and their ideas.
- The best leaders ask before they direct.
- Listening transforms leadership.
- If you want to make life hard for yourself, start telling people things.

NOTES

LEADING FROM YOUR POSITION TITLE VS COMPETENCIES.

RULE: TITLES DON'T INSPIRE TRUST. COMPETENT ACTIONS AND INSPIRED RESULTS, DO.

- Beware of the walking, talking resume.
- Often breaks the rule of Management vs Leadership.
- Focuses more on self-preservation than unifying progress.
- Tendency to micro-manage to cover up for obvious deficiencies.
- Creates confusion, then positions themselves as the only solution.
- Builds credibility through consistent action, not status.
- Demonstrates the standard before demanding it.
- Uses expertise to create clarity, not dependence.
- Develops capability instead of guarding authority.
- Lets inspired results speak louder than the title.

NOTES

PEOPLE WANT TO BE SEEN FOR THE VALUE THEY BRING.

RULE: RECOGNITION IS THE CURRENCY OF ENGAGEMENT.

- Life metrics beat work metrics every single time.
- People will forego other things of value to be recognised for the value they bring.
- Acknowledgement leads to loyalty.
- Celebrate your wins and the wins of your people proudly and publicly.
- People who feel valued will go the extra mile.
- Recognition drives momentum.
- Valued people create valuable results.
- Acknowledgement breeds loyalty.
- Unseen contributions lead to visible disengagement.
- As a leader you must recognise this, and much, much more about the human being.

NOTES

...BECAUSE

99% OF YOUR WINS WILL COME FROM THE EFFORTS OF YOUR PEOPLE.

RULE: PEOPLE WILL SUPPORT WHAT THEY CAN HELP TO CREATE.

- A good idea is a good idea, no matter where it comes from.
- Share the spoils.
- Always be willing to do in demonstration what you are asking of your people.
- The credit belongs to the team.
- Shared success builds shared responsibility.
- Recognition is a powerful motivator.
- It causes people pain to be overlooked.
- You do not want this pain being delivered back to you. It may have multiplied in your absence.

NOTES

BUY-IN vs COMPLIANCE

RULE: WHEN THE VALUE OF THE RELATIONSHIP GOES AWAY, SO DOES THE RELATIONSHIP

- You might get short-term results, but long-term success is undermined.
- When the cat's away, the mice will play.
- Cut your nose off to spite your face is always a strategy for disaster.
- If you did it wrong, look for skill vs will in the resulting response.
- Work to understand first, and then to be understood.
- If they only feel competent when you're there, you failed.
- If they only feel incompetent when you are there, you failed.
- Relationships of value are based on trust and reciprocity.
- The terms of the deal make the deal. Bait and switch at your own risk.

NOTES

CONNECT PEOPLE TO PEOPLE AND TO RESOURCES REQUIRED TO BE SUCCESSFUL

RULE: RIGHT ACTIONS > RIGHT FREQUENCY = SUCCESS

- Work to create a positive network effect.
- Recognise and operate away from zero sum thinking.
- Can do attitude and solution-based approach.
- Open door policy.
- Prioritises people, experience and needs over paperwork and numbers in boxes.
- Offers guidance and support across multiple mediums instead of directive and constraints that disconnect and deteriorate trust.
- Speaks last at the meeting.
- Success doesn't happen in isolation.

NOTES

SPEAK TO THE ACTIONS

RULE: EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION IS AT THE TOP OF THE LIST OF 'CRITICAL' LIFE SKILLS

- Emotionally intelligent enough to leave their feelings out of critical communications.
- Prioritises building and maintaining strong relationships instead of always trying to win.
- Considers multiple viewpoints when assessing a situation.
- Guided by events, not feelings.
- Who, what, when, where, how and sometimes even why.
- Understands the pressures put on others to perform.
- Acknowledges fault when responsible for error.
- Hears horses, not zebras.
- Conscious of the power of attribution error.
- Works to understand and then be understood.
- Understands the difference between problem solving and problem admiration.
- Strong relationships outlast quick wins.

NOTES

FORMALITY VS HUMANISATION

RULE: YOU DON'T WANT TO BE SO UNIQUE THAT YOU CANNOT BE CONNECTED TO

- ...or so that others cannot connect to you either.
- We are all very unique...in much the same way.
- Predictable difference is a wonderful thing...it dramatically improves the potential for meaningful connection.
- We don't like perfect. We don't know how to connect to it.
- Not afraid to be open, honest and transparent.
- Highlights own failings in lessons to guide others.
- Knows how to say, "I was wrong."
- Doesn't hold grudges and moves on with things quickly.
- Leads from competencies instead of position title.
- Trust comes from you, not your suit and tie or your fancy title.

NOTES

YOU HAVE 3 CHOICES

RULE: IF YOU WANT A PERSON TO BE MORE RESPONSIBLE, GIVE THEM SOMETHING TO BE RESPONSIBLE FOR...NOW GET OUT OF THE WAY.

- You choose...Independence.
- You collaborate...Interdependence.
- You defer your choice to a 3rd party agency...Dependent.
- Options 1 and 2 should be prioritised always.
- Option 3 should be used with extreme caution.
- Buy-in over compliance.
- Accountability is a priority.
- Learn about 'Skill vs Will'
- Knows when to change the conversation.
- Change your people, or change your people.
- Accountability is the cornerstone of leadership.
- Great leaders facilitate, not dictate.

NOTES

50/50 RULE

RULE: IF I'M WORKING HARDER TOWARDS THE ACHIEVEMENT OF YOUR GOALS THAN YOU ARE...THEN I'M OUT.

- Expects not to be asked to commit more of their time, energy, effort, care, attention, resources...etc, to the pursuit and achievement of the goals of others beyond what those others are willing to commit themselves.
- Doesn't meet people where they are. Creates a new standard and guides them forward.
- Believes that everyone has the capacity for great ideas.
- Does not lower their own standards to find out what they are.
- Pushes away the interested and pulls in the committed.
- Believes in the value of each individual.
- Personalises feedback.
- Works hard to include others in the change process.
- Understands Skill vs Will.
- Knows when to change the conversation.

NOTES

CELEBRATE YOUR WINS

RULE: CREATE A FORUM WHERE IDEAS CAN BE SHARED AND POSITIVELY RESPONDED TO IN THE DIRECTION OF GROWTH AND PROGRESS.

- That's it for this one...celebrate your wins. Easy.
- Celebrate publicly.
- Personalise wins where you can.
- Recognise individual efforts and those of the team.
- Follows the Value Equation and Hierarchy to maintain momentum and morale.
- Celebration fuels momentum for future success.
- Positive reinforcement encourages repeat success.
- Over-incentivising risks creating a culture of 'What have you done for me lately?'
- Adults like to be recognised as adults.
- Certificates of recognition should come on fancy card and be signed by the big wigs. Not printed in the office and stuck to the walls like a year 7 classroom.

NOTES

IDENTITY DRIVES BEHAVIOUR — PART 1

RULE: WHEN PEOPLE FEEL VALUED, THEY ACT LIKE THEY ARE VALUABLE.

- Understands that life metrics beat work metrics...every single time.
- Works to understand what these are in the life of the individual.
- Works to establish a towards/asset-based mindset.
- Understands the complexities of change and uses principled thinking as a guide.
- Knows not to get so attached to an outcome that they wouldn't accept something better.
- What was true yesterday is not necessarily true today.
- In times of instability and stress, we tend to reach for what we know, not necessarily what is good for us.
- Is extremely familiar with the feeling of learning.
- Understands that the things you think about the most express themselves in your words, actions, behaviours and inevitably your results.

NOTES

IDENTITY DRIVES BEHAVIOUR — PART 2

RULE: WHEN PEOPLE FEEL VALUED, THEY ACT LIKE THEY ARE VALUABLE.

- Understands the difference between theory and practice. Look it up.
- Understands that some people's strategy for communicating their value is based in defensiveness.
- Works to establish value as a priority and move to a strategy where value is actively promoted instead of aggressively defended.
- Change is a choice. Not all choices are easy. These ones can be extra tricky.
- Hard choices are choices too.
- Negativity does not make you unique, your ability to overcome it does.
- People will behave according to how they are recognised.
- Perception is everything.
- Become the thing that changes.

NOTES

POSITIVELY STATED LANGUAGE

RULE: IF THE TOOLS THAT YOU USE TO INTERACT WITH, INTERPRET AND UNDERSTAND THE WORLD ARE OFF...YOUR PERCEPTIONS WILL BE OFF.

- Use language that supports change in a positive direction.
- Your language moves in the direction of the desired change.
- Uses language that articulates the positive behaviours/actions/results you want to see.
- Does not use language that articulates and highlights the problem as part of the solution.
- Understand frames, frameworks and start to use them to enhance the way you communicate.
- The power of an idea is found in your ability to articulate it.
- Understand what a litote is....I know, fancy, right?

NOTES